

THE STATE OF THE WORLD

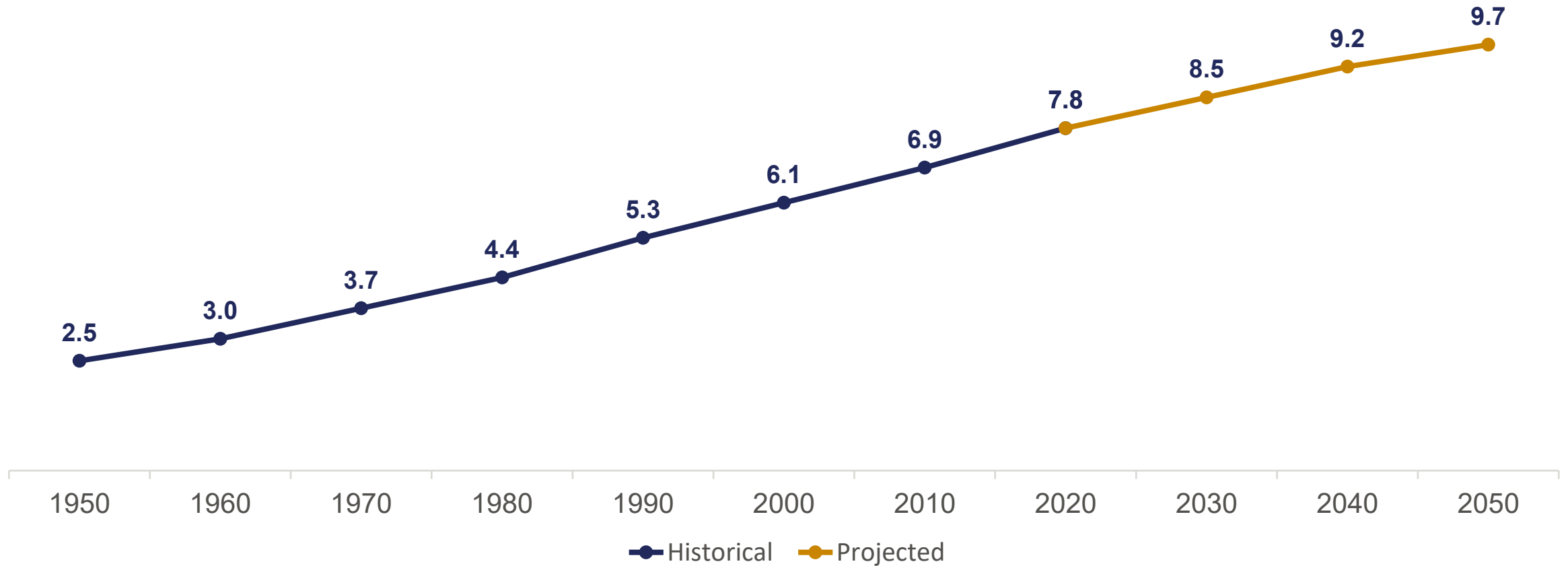
The State of the World in Our Generation

Nehemiah 1:4 *“And it came to pass, when I heard these words, that I sat down and wept, and mourned certain days, and fasted, and prayed before the God of heaven”*



The growth of world population

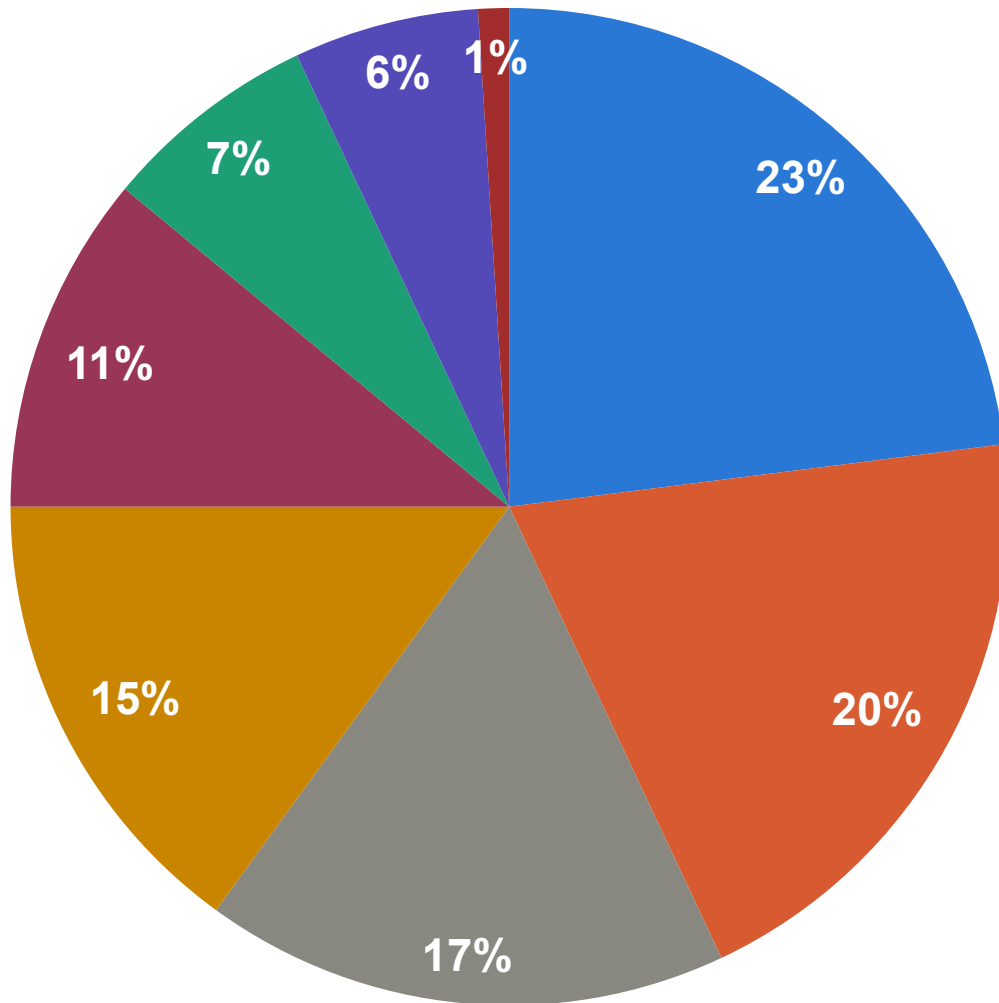
Billions of people, 1950–2050 (2030–2050 are UN projections)



World population has more than tripled since 1950 and is projected to approach 9.7 billion by 2050. Source: United Nations, World Population Prospects.

Major world religions

Share of global population, by religious affiliation



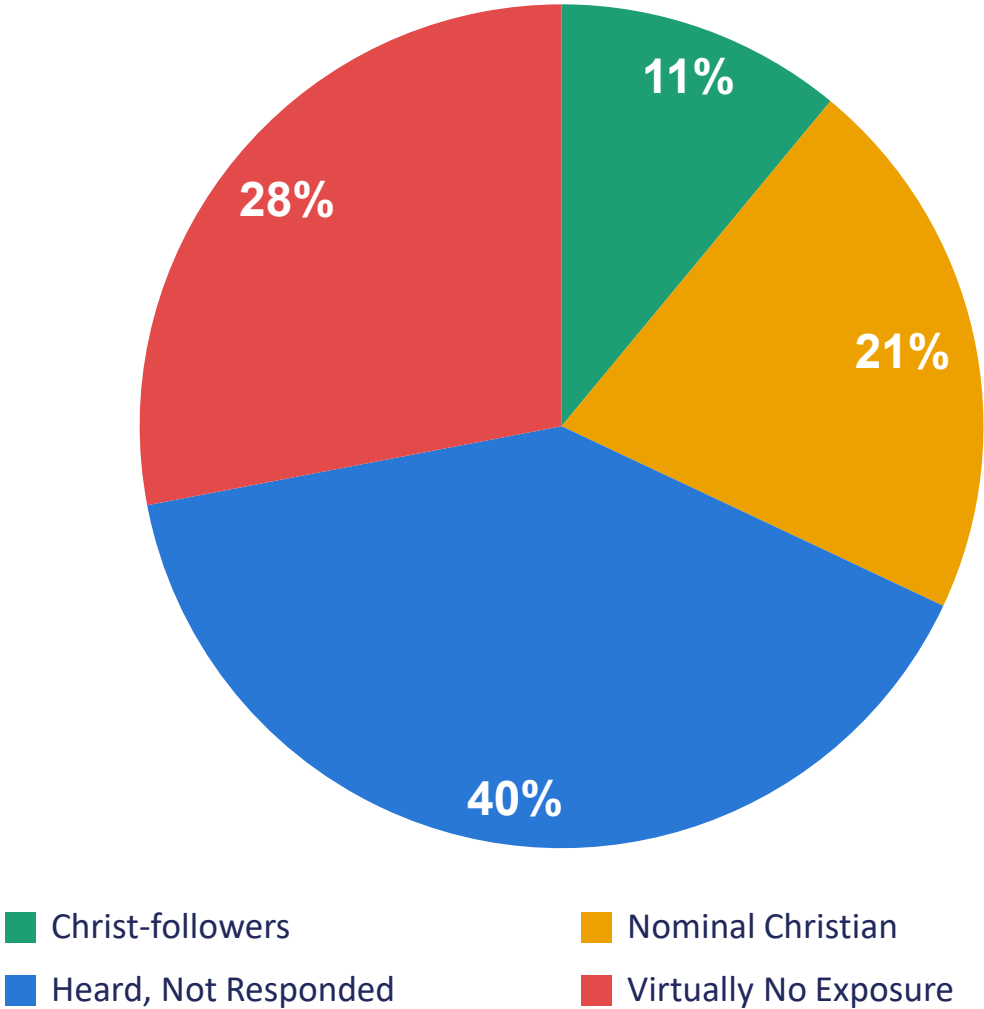
**Evangelical figure uses the widest definition (Zurlo's "Wider Evangelical" typology, ~930M). Sources: Pew Research Center, Center for the Study of Global Christianity.*

Status of world evangelization

World population: 8,300,000,000 (8.3 billion), 2026

% of population	Population	Category
11%	0.91 billion	Christ-followers
21%	1.74 billion	Nominal Christian
40%	3.32 billion	Heard, Not Responded
28%	2.32 billion	Virtually No Exposure

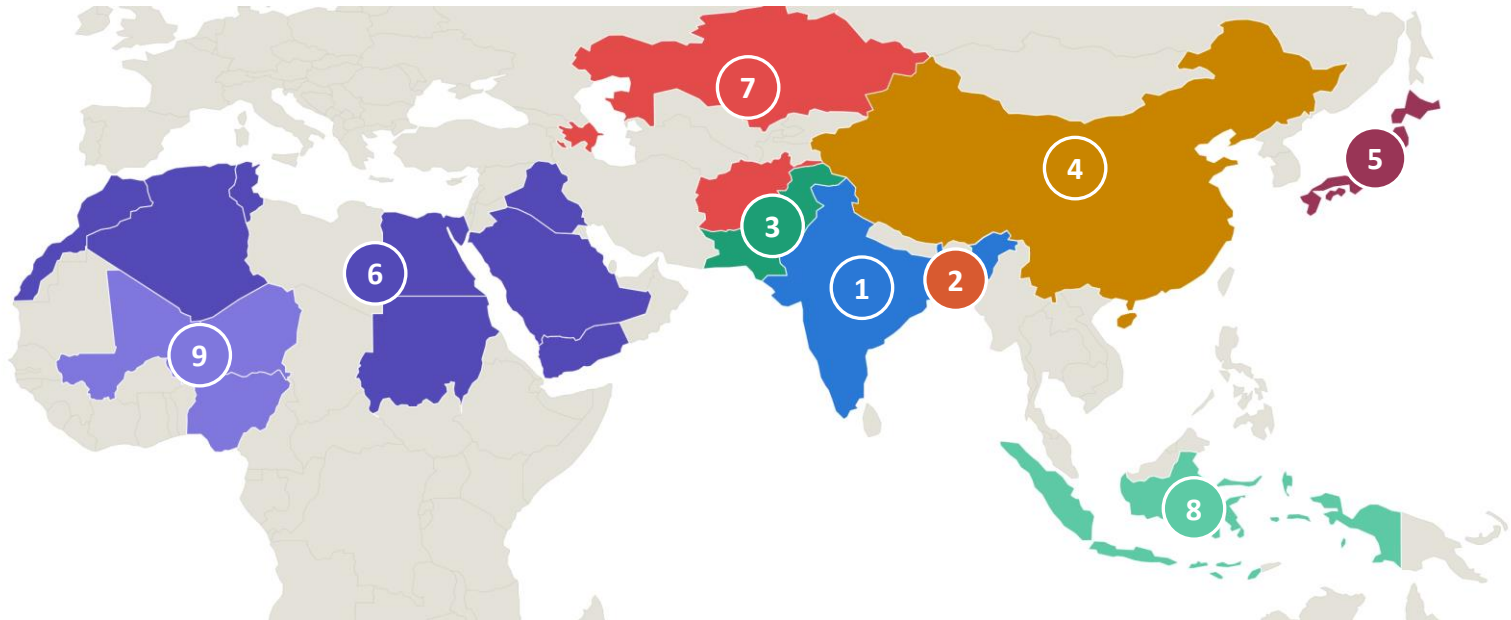
Rounded percentages and values.



Source: Joshua Project, Status of World Evangelization. Categories reflect exposure and response to the Gospel among the world's people groups.

The 10/40 Window: Where the most unreached people live

More than 90% of the world's unreached peoples live in this band across North Africa, the Middle East, and Asia called the “10/40 Window”



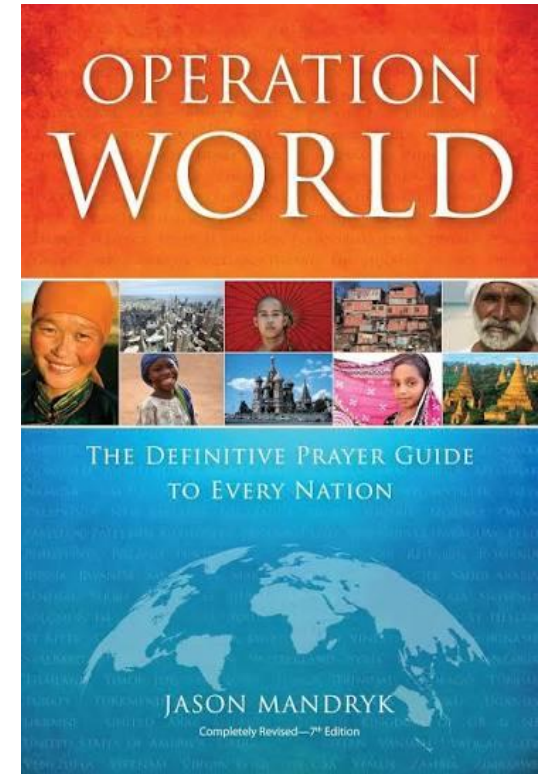
- 1 India**
Dozens of unreached people groups, including the Brahman and Yadav
- 2 Bangladesh**
Bengali Muslims — roughly 135 million people — the largest unreached people group in the world
- 3 Pakistan**
Large Muslim groups such as the Jat and Arain remain largely unreached
- 4 China**
Hundreds of unreached groups, including many Han Chinese subgroups and ethnic minorities
- 5 Japan**
Less than 2% of the 117 million Japanese people in Japan are evangelical
- 6 Middle East & North Africa**
Egypt, Algeria, Morocco, Iraq, Yemen, Saudi Arabia, Sudan, Tunisia
- 7 Central Asia**
Kazakhstan, Azerbaijan, Afghanistan, and neighboring nations
- 8 Indonesia**
The world's largest Muslim population (245 million), spread across thousands of islands
- 9 West Africa**
Nigeria, Niger, Mali — the Hausa, Fulani, Kanuri, and Bambara peoples

What God Has Done in a Generation

*“Patrick Johnstone, when queried in 1979 about the most difficult places for gospel breakthrough, named **Mongolia** and **Albania**. Today, there are at least 40,000 **Mongolian** believers. **Albania** is open and churches are growing.*

*Who among us, 30 years ago, could have envisioned over 100 million **Chinese** Christians, massive people movements in **Iran, Algeria** and **Sudan**, breakthroughs in **Mozambique, Cambodia** and **Nepal**, and the beginnings of freedom for hundreds of millions of oppressed in **India**?
Only God!”*

— Operation World, 7th edition (2010), p. 4



Five Opened Doors

Communist collapse. A dictator's death. Genocide. Political upheaval. Each of these nations was closed to open Christian witness within living memory — and each has since come open.



Mongolia

40,000+

evangelicals today,
from almost none in
1990 — communist
rule ended that year



Albania

17,000

believers today; a
constitutionally
atheist state from
1967 until 1990–91



Nepal

11% / yr

evangelical growth
since Nepal became a
secular republic in
2008



Cambodia

290,000+

evangelicals, growing
about 9% a year since
the Khmer Rouge fell
in 1979



South Korea

16–20%

evangelical today, and
among the world's
leading missionary-
sending nations

“For a great door and effectual is opened unto me, and there are many adversaries.”

– 1 Corinthians 16:9

Bible Translation: Closer Than Ever

Wycliffe Bible Translators estimates that of the 7,394 languages spoken worldwide, only 522 are still considered vital for translation work.

7,394

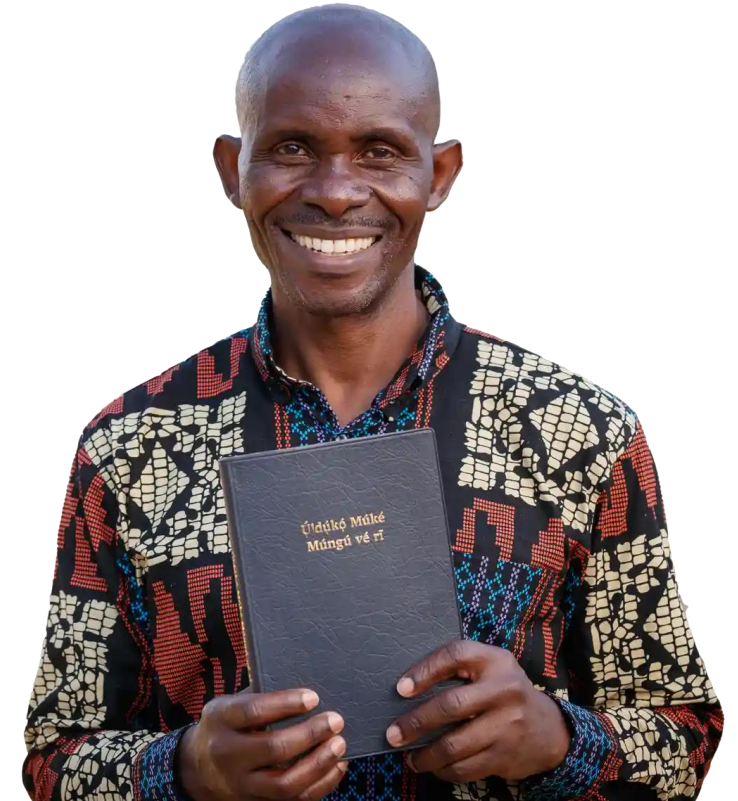
languages spoken in
the world today

522

languages still
considered vital for
translation work —
about 37 million
people

99%

of the world now has
access to some
Scripture in their own
language

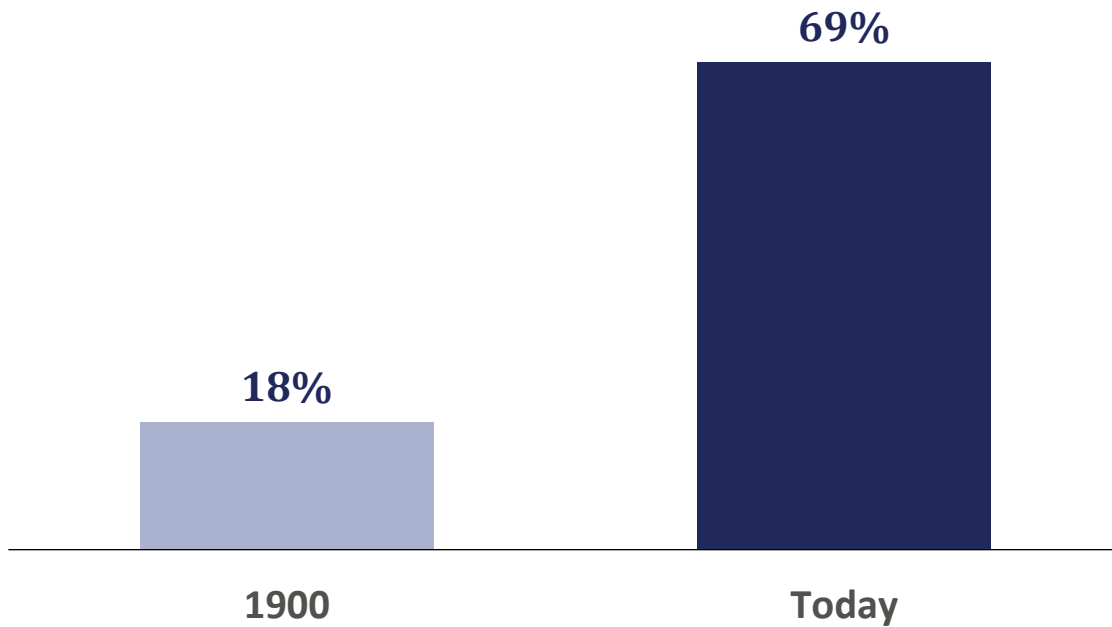


The remaining task is smaller than ever — and more reachable than ever.

Global Christianity: The Centre of Gravity Has Moved

The share of the world that is Christian is roughly the same as in 1900 — but where Christians live has changed completely.

Christians in Africa, Asia and Latin America



“This is an indication that missionary efforts of the past 200 years have borne incredible fruit, though at times it was slow in coming. Years and generations of prayer and faithful service to the unevangelized world by both missionaries and indigenous Christians have not been in vain.”

— Operation World, 7th edition (2010), p. 5

“For from you sounded out the word of the Lord not only in Macedonia and Achaia, but also in every place your faith to God-ward is spread abroad; so that we need not to speak any thing.”
– 1 Thess 1:8

The Globalization of Missions

Churches outside Europe and North America are now sending missionaries in growing numbers.

Gaining momentum

- Ethiopia, Nigeria
- Brazil
- Philippines, South Korea
- India

Level at best, often declining

- North America
- Europe
- The Pacific

“Mission sending has recently gained or maintained momentum in countries such as Ethiopia, Nigeria, Brazil, Philippines, South Korea and others. Involvement by the more traditional sending regions of North America, Europe and the Pacific has stayed level at best and often declined. The world missions force is more multicultural and multinational than ever before.”

— Operation World, 7th edition (2010)

Media and Technological Advances

Where missionaries cannot go because of geographic or physical barriers, technology increasingly can.



Mobile phones



Satellite internet



Radio broadcasts



Discipleship apps



Streaming content

Technology and AI also have the potential to shorten translation timelines dramatically and help mission agencies deploy their resources far more strategically.

“The Internet as a tool for evangelism, discipleship, fellowship, worship and training is limited only by the creativity and commitment of Christians. The possibilities are endless. This tool, probably more than any other, will shape the nature of the Church and mission as the 21st Century unfolds. Paired inexorably with this is the phenomenal spread of mobile phones and their potential for evangelism and ministry.”

— Operation World, 7th edition (2010), p. 10

Areas of Strategic Focus: Cities

The world is urbanising fast — and the unreached are moving into its megacities.

58%

of the world lives in cities,
up from 30% in 1950

70%

projected to live in cities
by 2050

500+

cities now hold more than
a million people



As cities grow, unreached peoples are moving into them — putting churches in places like London within reach of peoples from across the world.

“The ‘threat’ of immigration could also be a great opportunity for Christian ministry — many migrants come from less-evangelized lands, and many others come as vibrant, witnessing Christians.”

— Operation World, 7th edition (2010), p. 14

Areas of Strategic Focus: India

The largest country on earth — and home to the largest concentration of unreached people anywhere.

1.47 billion

people — the largest country in the world, about 18% of the global population

1.1 billion

in “frontier” unreached groups with no known indigenous Christian community (Joshua Project)



Pray

- For Indian churches and national missionaries carrying the work
- For foreign missionaries navigating increasingly complex visa, immigration and ministry restrictions

Areas of Strategic Focus: China

The second-largest nation on earth, and overwhelmingly urban.

1.41 billion

people — the second-largest country in the world

135

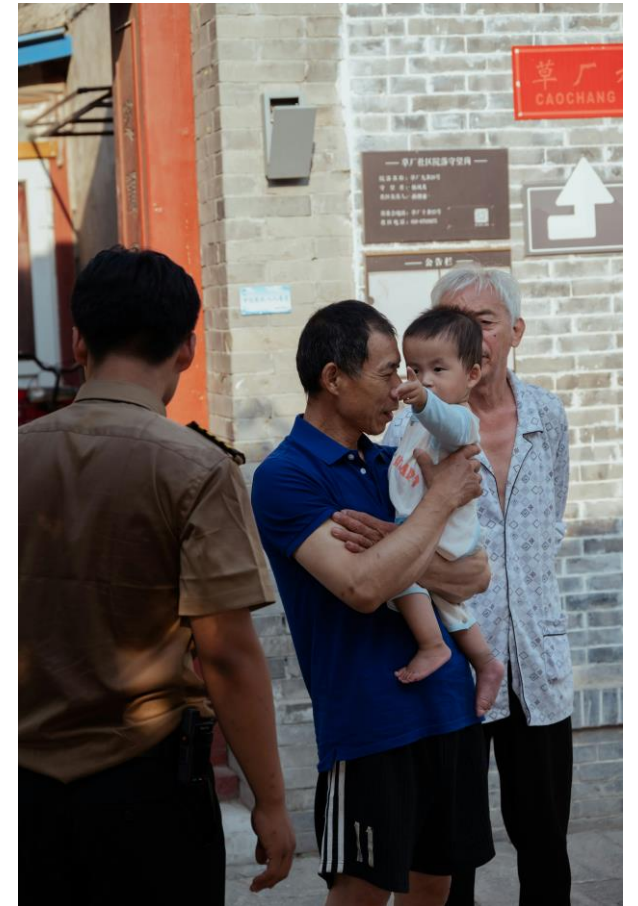
cities with more than one million residents

Pray

For many labourers to surrender their lives to go and live among the Chinese people.

Praise

China has opened the door to student and tourist visas once again.



Areas of Strategic Focus: The Muslim World

“In the past 20 years, more Muslims than ever before have come to Christ, more workers serve in Muslim heartlands, more agencies focus on these regions, and more sustained intercession is given for these peoples precious to God. There are the beginnings of what may well become a flood of Muslims discovering Jesus, demonstrating His Lordship over all peoples.”

— Operation World, 7th edition (2010), p. 8

Open or fairly open to the gospel

- Senegal, The Gambia, Sierra Leone
- Albania, Bosnia
- Kyrgyzstan, Azerbaijan
- Malaysia, the UAE
- Djibouti, Kuwait

Closed — but encouraging reports

- Iran and Algeria remain oppressive and largely closed to outsiders
- Yet reports of Christian growth in both are among the most encouraging anywhere



Some observers expect Saudi Arabia to permit churches for expatriates in the near future.

Areas of Strategic Focus: Africa

The world's fastest-growing populations are overwhelmingly African.

3.37%

annual growth in the Central African Republic — the fastest-growing country in the world

Also among the fastest-growing nations

Somalia · Niger · DR Congo · Sudan
Angola · Mali · Tanzania · Mozambique
Zambia · Mauritania · Uganda · Chad

Projected by 2050

Nigeria passes the United States to become the world's 3rd most populous country

DR Congo 8th largest, at about 217 million people

Ethiopia 9th largest, at about 215 million people



When We Hear...

“And it came to pass, when I heard these words, that I sat down and wept, and mourned certain days, and fasted, and prayed before the God of heaven,”

— Nehemiah 1:4 (KJV)

When We Hear...

⁴ “Then the king said unto me, For what dost thou make request? So I prayed to the God of heaven. ⁵ And I said unto the king, If it please the king, and if thy servant have found favour in thy sight, that thou wouldest send me unto Judah, unto the city of my fathers’ sepulchres, that I may build it.”

— Nehemiah 2:4–5 (KJV)